

DEVA ANAND

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Cloudflare
Austin, TX

Re: Security Engineering Intern

Dear Cloudflare Security Team,

I want to spend my next internship making systems harder to break, and Cloudflare is the rare place where that work protects billions of people and a free, open Internet at the same time. I am a Computer Science master's student at UMass Amherst, and security has been the part of engineering I take most seriously since well before grad school.

At Wysa I owned backend security and reliability for a multi-tenant NHS service used by 8+ UK clinical clients. That meant implementing AWS KMS encryption for sensitive clinical data, hardening authentication and rate limiting, and remediating 20+ VAPT findings with regression-tested fixes so the same class of issue could not quietly come back. Protecting real users' sensitive data was not a checkbox on that team, it was the product, and it taught me to think about the attack surface first and the feature second. That is the security-first mindset your team describes, and it is how I default to working.

I am also drawn to where security meets AI, which is increasingly Cloudflare's frontier. For a graded research project I studied how prefilling attacks weaken safety refusal in a safety-aligned LLM (Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct), extracting the model's internal refusal direction and showing behavioral refusal drop from 0.92 to 0.32 under attack, with proper controls and statistics. Digging into how a defense actually fails, instead of assuming it holds, is the same instinct I would bring to defending Cloudflare's systems. And I am not new to your platform: I built an AI research agent end to end on Cloudflare Workers, with Durable Objects, D1, and durable workflows that survive restarts and tool failures, so I would be productive on your stack quickly.

I will be honest that my security experience has been hands-on defensive engineering rather than formal application-security work, so I am genuinely excited to learn OWASP-depth and threat-research craft from engineers who defend systems at a scale almost no one else operates. I get things done, I like sharing what I learn, and protecting the free and open Internet is a mission I would be proud to work on. Thank you for considering my application, and I would welcome the chance to talk.

Sincerely,
Deva Anand